LEX-ARG · LÉXICO TRANSVERSAL

Lenguaje para argumentar, evaluar e interactuar

Teoría: lo que el C2 añade sobre el C1

199 expresiones propias en siete funciones, con su registro y el paper en que rinden · remisiones a WRT-P1, WRT-P2, SPK, RDG-P5, LST, UOE-P1 a UOE-P4 y LEX-IDI, LEX-PHV, LEX-COL y LEX-CNF

1 Cómo se evalúa y cómo usar el documento

Este documento reúne el léxico de las operaciones de un argumento: presentar una postura, conceder, matizar, refutar, evaluar, sopesar y concluir, y reaccionar en la conversación. Está organizado por función, no por tema: lo que importa es qué hace cada expresión dentro del argumento y en qué registro funciona.

1.1 · Dónde aparece en el examen

Parte	Cómo aparece	Qué exige
Writing Part 1 (essay)	Resumir y evaluar las ideas de dos textos y dar una postura propia.	Atribuir, conceder, matizar, refutar y concluir en registro escrito formal o neutro: §3–§8.
Writing Part 2 (article, letter, report, review)	Evaluar una obra, una medida o una propuesta y recomendar.	Evaluar (§7.4–§7.5), sopesar y recomendar (§8) en registro neutro; algo de §9 en el article y la review de tono vivo.
Speaking Parts 2 y 3	Negociar en pareja, el long turn y la discusión final.	Las versiones H y N de cada función (§4.3, §6.4, §9); reaccionar sin sonar a lista aprendida.
Reading y Listening	Las preguntas sobre la actitud o la postura del autor o del hablante.	Reconocer cuándo alguien concede, refuta, ironiza o se queja: §4, §6 y §9.
Use of English	Parts 1 y 4: colocaciones fijas y transformaciones.	La forma exacta: preposición, artículo y orden (beyond dispute among, borne out by, the upshot of).

1.2 · Qué cambia respecto al C1

Aspecto	C1	C2
Repertorio	Conectores generales: in my opinion, on the other hand, however.	Expresiones que nombran la operación: it would be churlish to deny, it does not follow that, the upshot is.
Evaluar	good, convincing, weak.	Una escala precisa (watertight → untenable, §7.2) y el criterio explícito (judged by sales alone, §7.3).
Refutar	I disagree, this is not true.	Nombrar qué falla: la afirmación, el razonamiento o la fuente (§6).
Registro	Formal frente a informal, en general.	La misma función en tres registros y control del desajuste (§2).

1.3 · Cómo leer las tablas

- Columnas: **Expresión · Reg. · Paper · Significado y uso · Ejemplo**.

- **Reg. E**, escrito formal (essay, report, carta formal); **N**, neutro, vale en cualquier paper; **H**, hablado o escrito muy informal (Speaking, article o review de tono vivo).
- **Paper W1**, Writing Part 1 (essay); **W2**, Writing Part 2 (article, letter, report, review); **S**, Speaking. El primero es donde la expresión rinde más.
- sb, sth, X e Y marcan los huecos; lo que va entre paréntesis es opcional y la barra separa variantes.
- **Ya en otra teoría**, al final de cada sección: expresiones de la misma función explicadas en otro documento, que aquí solo se remiten. Cuando LEX-ARG añade un patrón a una expresión ya vista, la fila da solo lo nuevo y cita la otra teoría.
- Cada sección se cierra con un ítem modelo de Part 1 o Part 4, el formato de LEX-ARG_Practica. La §10 reúne todo por palabra clave para el repaso.

> CLAVE
> En el examen no puntúa la rareza, sino la precisión. Una expresión de esta lista mal ajustada a la función o al registro resta más que una sencilla bien usada. El objetivo no es meterlas todas, sino tener la exacta para cada movimiento del argumento.

2 Una función, tres registros

La misma operación se dice de forma distinta según el paper. La tabla recorre las funciones del documento en los tres registros; cada expresión está explicada en su sección.

Función	Essay o report (E)	Article, review o carta (N)	Speaking (H)
Afirmar	There can be little doubt that the scheme has failed.	There's no question that the scheme has failed.	Let's face it, the scheme's been a flop.
Conceder	It would be churlish to deny that the scheme has had some successes.	To give the scheme its due, it has had some successes.	Fair point – it's had its moments.
Matizar	This is true only to the extent that the figures can be trusted.	This holds, but only if you trust the figures.	Well, yes – if you believe the figures.
Refutar	The claim does not bear close scrutiny.	The claim simply doesn't hold up.	Oh, come off it – that's just not true.
Evaluar pruebas	The evidence is largely anecdotal.	It's a nice story, but it proves very little.	Come on – one story doesn't prove anything.
Concluir	In the final analysis, the costs outweigh the benefits.	The upshot is that the scheme costs more than it delivers.	The bottom line is, it's just not worth it.

Qué delata un registro desajustado

- E en el Speaking: It is incumbent upon the government to act suena a discurso leído; en la Part 3, it's really up to the government to act.
- H en el essay: come off it, the bottom line is o tell me about it rompen el tono aunque la idea sea buena.
- Mezcla en la misma frase: *It is incontrovertible that the plan is a bit of a mess. La primera mitad es E y la segunda H, y el lector nota el choque.
- Lo neutro (N) vale en todas partes: ante la duda, la opción N es la segura.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

E no es mejor que N. Un essay que acumula expresiones E suena rígido y forzado; la escala del C2 premia el control del registro, no su elevación (WRT-P1 §6.3).

3 Presentar una postura

Afirmar con la fuerza que permiten las pruebas, ni más ni menos, y presentar la postura ajena antes de evaluarla. Afirmar con más seguridad de la que se puede sostener es lo que el examinador lee como overstating the case (WRT-P1 §5.3).

3.1 · Afirmar con firmeza

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
beyond dispute	E	W1 W2	fuera de toda discusión: be beyond dispute, put sth beyond dispute. Solo para lo que de verdad nadie discute	That the policy cut emissions is beyond dispute; whether it was worth the cost is not.
there can be little doubt that	E	W1 W2	apenas cabe duda de que: versión graduada de there is no doubt that (UOE-P4 §4); little deja un margen mínimo	There can be little doubt that the new law has saved lives.
incontrovertible	E	W1 W2	irrefutable, que no admite discusión: incontrovertible evidence / proof / fact	The documents are incontrovertible proof that the minister knew.
it stands to reason (that)	N	W1 W2 S	es lógico que, cae por su propio peso: lo que se sigue del sentido común	It stands to reason that exhausted drivers are more likely to crash.
it is my contention that	E	W1	sostengo que: presenta la tesis propia que se va a defender; sustantivo de contend (WRT-P1 §4.3)	It is my contention that the decline began long before the internet.
be (firmly) of the view that	N	W1 W2 S	estar convencido de que; firmly o strongly lo refuerzan. Más personal que take the view that (LEX-COL §7)	I am firmly of the view that museums should be free.
have every reason to	N	W1 W2 S	tener motivos de sobra para; en negativa, have no reason to	Residents have every reason to doubt the council's promises.
self-evident	E	W1	evidente por sí mismo; muy a menudo, para cuestionar lo que otros dan por evidente: it is far from self-evident that. Formación, UOE-P3 §6.4	It is far from self-evident that more testing produces better schools.
make no bones about	N	W2 S	no andarse con rodeos sobre algo: make no bones about (the fact) that	She makes no bones about her dislike of modern architecture.

3.2 · Afirmar con cautela

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
I would venture (to suggest) that	N	W1 W2 S	me atrevería a decir que: propone una idea discutible con modestia	I would venture that most readers never notice the difference.
it is not unreasonable to suppose that	E	W1	cabe suponer que: la doble negación rebaja la afirmación (RDG-P5 §4.3)	It is not unreasonable to suppose that prices will rise again next year.
it would seem that	E	W1 W2	parece ser que: más distante que it seems; deja la responsabilidad en los datos	It would seem that the warnings were ignored.
tentative / tentatively	N	W1 W2	provisional, con reservas: a tentative conclusion / suggestion, I would tentatively suggest. Como actitud del autor en Reading, RDG-P5 §4.4	The data allow only a tentative conclusion.
as I understand it	N	S W2	según tengo entendido: deja abierta la posibilidad de estar mal informado	As I understand it, the scheme is voluntary.
for what it's worth	H	S W2	por si sirve de algo: presenta la opinión propia quitándole importancia. Como palabra clave de Part 4, UOE-P4 §7	For what it's worth, I think she made the right decision.

3.3 · Señalar lo esencial

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
the heart of the matter / argument	N	W1 W2 S	el meollo, el núcleo: at the heart of, lie at the heart of	At the heart of the argument lies a simple question: who pays?
the crux (of the matter)	N	W1 W2 S	el quid de la cuestión: the crux of the matter is that. En oral, también the crux of it (SPK §4.2)	The crux of the matter is not cost but control.
what is at issue	E	W1 W2	lo que se discute, lo que está en cuestión: the point at issue; at issue no implica duda, sino debate. No es «lo que está en juego», que es at stake	What is at issue is not the policy itself but the way it was introduced.
the real dividing line	N	W1 W2	lo que de verdad separa dos posturas, frente a la diferencia aparente: the dividing line between X and Y	The real dividing line is not between young and old but between owners and renters.
underlying	N	W1 W2	subyacente, de fondo: the underlying problem / assumption / cause; verbo underlie. Formación, UOE-P3 §7.3	The underlying assumption is that people always act in their own interest.

3.4 · Presentar posturas ajenas

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
proponents / detractors	N	W1 W2	partidarios / detractores: proponents of X; detractors suele ir con posesivo (its detractors)	Its proponents see the tax as a nudge; its detractors see it as a tax on the poor.
the prevailing view	N	W1 W2	la opinión dominante; la que se repite sin examinarla es conventional / received wisdom (LEX-COL §5)	The prevailing view among economists is that the effect will be small.
espouse	E	W1	abrazar, defender (una causa, una idea, unos valores)	She espoused the cause of prison reform long before it was fashionable.
champion (v.)	N	W1 W2	abanderar, defender públicamente (una causa, a un grupo)	The paper has long championed the rights of tenants.
the case for / against X	N	W1 W2 S	los argumentos a favor / en contra: the case against X rests on, make the case for	The case against the motorway rests largely on its cost.
purport to	E	W1 W2	pretender, afirmar (ser o hacer algo): purport to be / to show; sugiere que quizá no lo es	The study purports to show that diet has no effect on mood.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Afirma con fuerza solo lo que lo resiste. Beyond dispute e incontrovertible valen para hechos que nadie discute; aplicados a una opinión, el lector ve la exageración y la postura pierde crédito. Para lo discutible, la cautela de 3.2 no es debilidad: es precisión.

Ya en otra teoría

there is no doubt that, beyond doubt (UOE-P4 §4) · contend, maintain, assert, advocate (WRT-P1 §4.3) · the way I see it (SPK §4.2) · I'd be inclined to think, there's a case for saying (SPK §4.6) · I'd hazard a guess that (SPK §5.2) · would have us believe, claim, allege (RDG-P5 §4.1) · for my money, there's a school of thought that (LST §3.2) · boil down to, come down to (LEX-PHV §15)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 4

No historian would question that the reforms improved public health.

DISPUTE

That the reforms improved public health _____ historians.

Respuesta: IS BEYOND DISPUTE AMONG (4 palabras).

También: IS BEYOND ALL DISPUTE AMONG · IS NOT IN DISPUTE AMONG · IS NOT OPEN TO DISPUTE AMONG · IS NOT A MATTER OF DISPUTE AMONG · IS NOT A SUBJECT OF DISPUTE AMONG.

Qué se puntúa: is beyond dispute (la oración con that hace de sujeto, así que hace falta is; no historian would question pasa a la forma fija) y among, que introduce a los historiadores; amongst vale igual. *Is indisputable among cambia la palabra clave: el ítem vale 0.

4 Conceder

Conceder bien separa una postura de C1 de una de C2: se reconoce lo que vale en la otra postura y se gira hacia la propia. WRT-P1 §5.3 y SPK §6.3 ya dan el núcleo (granted, much as, I'll grant that); aquí, el resto del repertorio.

4.1 · Reconocer lo que vale

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
it would be churlish to deny (that)	E	W1 W2	sería mezquino negar que: concede un mérito con elegancia antes de criticar. Churlish: grosero, mezquino	It would be churlish to deny that the festival has brought money into the town.
in fairness (to sb) / to be fair	N	W1 W2 S	para ser justos (con alguien); to be fair, más oral	In fairness to the council, it inherited most of these problems.
to give sb / sth their due	N	W2 S	hay que reconocerle (a alguien) que: to give her her due, to give the film its due	To give the director her due, the final scene is superbly handled.
there is no getting away from (the fact that)	N	W2 S	no hay forma de esquivar algo incómodo: hay que admitirlo	There's no getting away from the fact that the town needs the jobs.
not without merit	E	W1 W2	con cierto mérito: litotes que concede poco (RDG-P5 §4.3)	The proposal is not without merit, but it ignores the cost of maintenance.
it must be conceded that	E	W1	hay que reconocer que: concede sin primera persona	It must be conceded that the figures have improved.
sb has a point	N	S W1 W2	algo de razón tiene: you have a point, she has a point there	He has a point – nobody actually asked the residents.

4.2 · Conceder y girar

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
it is one thing to X, (and / but) quite another to Y	N	W1 W2 S	una cosa es X y otra muy distinta Y: concede lo primero para rechazar lo segundo	It is one thing to criticise a policy, quite another to propose a better one.
(be) all very well / all well and good	N	W2 S	eso está muy bien, pero…: concede con cierta impaciencia y anuncia una objeción	Lower taxes are all very well, but someone has to pay for the hospitals.
even granting that	E	W1	aun admitiendo que: concede por hipótesis para mostrar que no basta	Even granting that the figures are accurate, they cover only a single year.
whatever its merits	N	W1 W2	sean cuales sean sus méritos: deja el mérito sin discutir y pasa a la objeción	Whatever its merits as entertainment, the film is a poor guide to history.
that may (well) be so, but	N	S W2	puede que sea así, pero: acepta el dato sin aceptar la conclusión	That may well be so, but it doesn't make the decision any fairer.

4.3 · En la conversación

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
point taken	H	S	entendido, lo acepto: reconoce una crítica breve y suele cerrar el tema	Point taken – I should have checked the figures first.
fair point	H	S	buen argumento, en eso tienes razón; suele seguirle un but	Fair point. But it still doesn't explain the delay.
I stand corrected	N	S W2	rectifico, tienes razón: tras la corrección de un dato; cortés, a veces irónico	Twelve, not ten? I stand corrected.
you've got me there	H	S	ahí me has pillado: no tengo respuesta para eso	You've got me there – I hadn't thought about the cost.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Conceder no es cambiar de bando. Lo concedido tiene que ser real pero secundario, y el giro tiene que llegar enseguida: una concesión que se alarga (It would be churlish to deny that the plan has merits. Indeed, it has many…) acaba defendiendo la postura contraria. En la Part 3 del Speaking, point taken y fair point van seguidos de lo tuyo; solos, parecen una rendición.

Ya en otra teoría

granted, much as, there is something to be said for, this is not to say that (WRT-P1 §5.3) · admittedly, mind you (SPK §4.3) · I won't deny it, I'll grant that, I'll give them that, I take your point, I'd go along with that (SPK §6.3) · fair enough (LST §3.6) · that said, having said that, even so, for all that (LST §2.3) · be that as it may, come what may, for all + noun (UOE-P2 §9.2) · Frail though she was (UOE-P2 §9.1) · give credit where credit is due (LEX-CNF §10.4)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 1

It would be _____ to deny that the new library has been popular; the question is whether the town can afford to keep it open.

A churlish **B** boorish **C** surly **D** curt

Respuesta: A (churlish) · it would be churlish to deny: sería mezquino negarlo. Es la fórmula fija para conceder un mérito antes de objetar, y the question is whether trae la objeción.

B boorish es «tosco, maleducado» en el trato; no forma la fórmula de concesión.

C surly es «hosco, malhumorado» y se dice de personas y gestos (a surly waiter).

D curt es «seco, cortante» y se dice de respuestas (a curt reply).

5 Matizar

Matizar es decir hasta dónde vale una afirmación: en qué condiciones, en qué sentido y con qué grado de certeza. Es lo que la escala de C2 llama ideas complejas, y lo que separa una evaluación de una opinión (WRT-P1 §5).

5.1 · Limitar el alcance

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
to the extent that / in so far as	E	W1	en la medida en que: limita una afirmación a una condición; in so far as se escribe también insofar as	To the extent that the figures can be trusted, the scheme has worked.
as such (= en sí mismo)	N	W1 W2	en sí mismo, propiamente dicho; va tras el sustantivo que matiza (not a ban as such). El sentido «en cuanto tal» está en UOE-P2 §4. Como «por tanto» se oye, pero se censura: en el essay, therefore	The council has not banned cars as such; it has simply made parking almost impossible.
strictly speaking	N	W1 W2 S	en sentido estricto: precisa el término antes de usarlo	Strictly speaking, the charge is not a tax, but it will feel like one.
all (other) things being equal	E	W1	en igualdad de condiciones: limita una previsión a que nada más cambie	All things being equal, a shorter working week should raise productivity.
barring	E	W1 W2	salvo (que haya): barring accidents / a last-minute change	Barring a last-minute change of heart, the bill will become law in May.
within reason	N	W2 S	dentro de lo razonable	Staff can work from home whenever they like, within reason.

5.2 · Distinguir y redefinir

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
mutually exclusive	N	W1 W2 S	incompatibles entre sí: si se da uno, no se da el otro; muy a menudo en negativa (need not be mutually exclusive)	Economic growth and a cleaner environment need not be mutually exclusive.
a precondition (for / of)	N	W1 W2	condición previa, requisito: lo que tiene que darse antes	Political stability is a precondition for foreign investment.
necessary but not sufficient	E	W1	condición necesaria pero no suficiente	Funding is a necessary but not a sufficient condition for a good school.
a false dichotomy	E	W1	una falsa disyuntiva: presentar como incompatibles dos cosas que no lo son	To choose between safety and freedom here is to accept a false dichotomy.
conflate X with / and Y	E	W1 W2	confundir dos cosas distintas, tratarlas como una; sustantivo conflation	The debate conflates popularity with quality.
draw a distinction (between)	N	W1 W2 S	distinguir entre; a fine / clear distinction	We need to draw a distinction between what is legal and what is fair.
a matter of degree (rather than kind)	E	W1	una cuestión de grado, no de naturaleza	The difference between the two systems is a matter of degree rather than kind.

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
a corollary (of)	E	W1	consecuencia lógica, corolario	The corollary of cheaper flights is more crowded skies.
per se	E	W1 W2	en sí, por sí mismo: como as such (5.1), más formal; va tras el sustantivo	The problem is not tourism per se but the way it is managed.

5.3 · Graduar la certeza

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
demonstrably	E	W1 W2	de forma demostrable: demonstrably false / true / better	The claim that the scheme pays for itself is demonstrably false.
conceivably / it is not inconceivable that	E	W1	es concebible que / no es descabellado pensar que: admiten una posibilidad remota	It is not inconceivable that the government will change its mind.
if at all	N	W1 W2 S	si es que (lo hace): rebaja casi a cero; también rarely, if ever y little, if any	The reforms have improved standards only slightly, if at all.
X, if not Y	N	W1 W2 S	X, por no decir Y: sube un grado sin afirmarlo del todo. También puede conceder a la baja, «X, aunque no Y» (a competent, if not inspired, performance): decide el contexto	Reversing the decision will be difficult, if not impossible.
it would be no exaggeration to say that	N	W1 W2	no es exagerado decir que: sube el grado anunciando que no se exagera	It would be no exaggeration to say that the internet has changed how we read.
to put it mildly	N	W2 S	por decirlo suavemente: avisa de que lo dicho se queda corto (como to say the least, UOE-P4 §7)	The launch was, to put it mildly, a disappointment.
not remotely	N	S W2	ni de lejos, en absoluto: not remotely interested / true; remotely solo en negativas y preguntas	I'm not remotely interested in who wins.
on some level	N	S W2	en cierto modo, en el fondo: admite algo que no se reconoce del todo	On some level, I think we all knew the project wouldn't work.
something of a + juicio	N	W1 W2 S	algo así como, en cierto modo: atenúa un juicio (something of an exaggeration / a gamble). El patrón está en LEX-COL §3.3	To call it a revolution is something of an exaggeration.

> CLAVE
> Matizar no es dudar de todo. Una limitación precisa (to the extent that, barring, per se) refuerza la postura porque muestra dónde termina; tres seguidas la disuelven. En el essay, una o dos por párrafo, justo donde la afirmación lo necesita.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

As such no significa «por tanto»: ese uso se oye cada vez más, pero un examinador culto lo nota. Y per se y as such van detrás de lo que matizan: not tourism per se, nunca *not per se tourism.

Ya en otra teoría

in a sense, in a way (SPK §4.3) · not so much X as Y, arguably (SPK §4.6) · far from, anything but, all but, if anything (RDG-P5 §6.3) · may well, tends to, it would be rash to (RDG-P5 §4.2) · up to a point, as far as it goes (WRT-P1 §5.3) · at best, at worst, in the main, to a large extent (UOE-P2 §6.3) · in that (UOE-P2 §7.1) · by and large (UOE-P1 §4.1) · border on, verge on (UOE-P1 §7.3) · in all likelihood (UOE-P4 §3.5)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 4

Saying that the bridge transformed the town would not be overstating the case.

EXAGGERATION

It _____ that the bridge transformed the town.

Respuesta: WOULD BE NO EXAGGERATION TO SAY (6 palabras).

También: WOULD NOT BE AN EXAGGERATION TO SAY · WOULDN'T BE AN EXAGGERATION TO SAY · WOULD HARDLY BE AN EXAGGERATION TO SAY · IS NO EXAGGERATION TO SAY · IS NOT AN EXAGGERATION TO SAY · ISN'T AN EXAGGERATION TO SAY.

Qué se puntúa: would be no exaggeration (el sustantivo con no recoge would not be overstating) y to say, que enlaza con la oración de that: con it de sujeto, el -ing de la frase 1 pasa a infinitivo. En lugar de say valen claim, suggest o state.

6 Refutar

Rebatir en el C2 no es decir que no: es decir qué falla (WRT-P1 §5.2). Hay tres blancos: la afirmación, que es falsa (6.1); el razonamiento, que no se sigue (6.2), y la fuente o el enfoque, que no es fiable o no es neutral (6.3). Negar, refutar y rebatir como verbos (deny, refute, rebut) están en LEX-CNF §10.2.

6.1 · Negar una afirmación

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
nothing could be further from the truth	N	W1 W2 S	nada más lejos de la realidad: rechaza de plano y suele seguir la versión correcta	Critics call the grant a gift to the rich. Nothing could be further from the truth: most of it goes to first-time buyers.
fly in the face of	N	W1 W2 S	contradecir de lleno (las pruebas, el sentido común, la experiencia)	The decision flies in the face of all the available evidence.
unfounded / groundless	N	W1 W2	infundado, sin base: unfounded fears / claims / allegations; groundless, algo más enfático. Formación, UOE-P3 §6.1	Fears that the factory would close proved unfounded.
debunk / explode a myth	N	W1 W2	desmontar, echar por tierra (un mito, una creencia popular) demostrando que es falso	The study debunks the myth that we use only ten per cent of our brains.

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
belie	E	W1 W2	1 desmentir: los hechos contradicen lo que se afirma; 2 ocultar, dar una impresión falsa (her smile belied her nerves)	The latest figures belie the minister's claim that the economy is recovering.
not bear (close) scrutiny / examination	E	W1	no resistir un examen detenido; en positivo, stand up to scrutiny (WRT-P1 §8.1)	The argument does not bear close examination.
the reverse is true	N	W1 W2 S	es al revés: invierte la afirmación ajena; también quite the reverse	We are often told that tourism protects old buildings; here, the reverse is true.
a fallacy	E	W1	una falacia: idea extendida pero falsa (it is a fallacy that) o razonamiento defectuoso (6.2); adjetivo fallacious	It is a fallacy that a bigger budget always produces better results.
discount	N	W1 W2	descartar, no tomar en serio: discount a possibility / a theory / sb's advice; no es «descontar»	We cannot discount the possibility that the figures were manipulated.

6.2 · Señalar el fallo de un razonamiento

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
it does not follow that	E	W1 W2	de ahí no se deduce que: separa la premisa de la conclusión; it hardly follows, más irónico	Many successful people left school early, but it does not follow that school is a waste of time.
beg the question	E	W1	en lógica, dar por probado lo que se quiere demostrar. El uso como «plantear la pregunta» está muy extendido, pero en el essay se censura: para eso, raise the question	To argue that the law is just because it is the law is to beg the question.
a straw man	N	W1 W2 S	falacia del hombre de paja: rebatir una versión deformada de la postura contraria; attack / set up a straw man	By pretending that his opponents want open borders, he is setting up a straw man.
caricature (n. / v.)	N	W1 W2	caricatura; caricaturizar: presentar la postura ajena exagerando sus rasgos para ridiculizarla	The article caricatures environmentalists as wealthy hypocrites.
cherry-pick	N	W1 W2 S	escoger solo los datos que convienen	The report cherry-picks the years in which the policy appeared to work.
correlation is not causation	N	W1 S	que dos cosas vayan juntas no prueba que una cause la otra; confuse correlation with causation	Pupils who eat breakfast get better marks, but correlation is not causation.
a false premise	E	W1	una premisa falsa: rest on a false premise; la premise es la idea de la que parte un razonamiento	The whole plan rests on a false premise: that people will pay more for slower trains.

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
a slippery slope	N	W1 S	pendiente resbaladiza: el argumento de que un primer paso llevará sin remedio a otros peores; a menudo se critica como falacia	Allowing one exception, they claim, would put us on a slippery slope.
a leap (of logic)	N	W1 W2 S	un salto lógico sin justificar: quite a leap; a leap of faith, creer sin pruebas	Moving from 'some teachers are poor' to 'the system is failing' is quite a leap.

6.3 · Cuestionar la fuente o el enfoque

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
peddle	N	W1 W2	difundir, vender (ideas falsas o interesadas), con desprecio: peddle myths / lies / conspiracy theories	Some websites peddle miracle cures to desperate patients.
purveyor	E	W1 W2	proveedor; con ironía, difusor de algo dudoso: a purveyor of gossip / half-truths	The magazine has become a purveyor of celebrity gossip.
romanticise	N	W1 W2 S	idealizar: presentar algo (el pasado, la pobreza, el campo) como más bonito de lo que es; a romanticised view of	The film romanticises rural poverty.
trivialise / demonise / sensationalise	N	W1 W2	otros verbos en -ise que critican el enfoque: quitar importancia, presentar como un monstruo, exagerar para impresionar. Formación, UOE-P3 §4.3	Coverage of the trial was sensationalised from the start.
(through) rose-tinted spectacles	N	W2 S	con gafas de color de rosa, idealizando; también rose-tinted glasses, y en americano rose-colored glasses	Older residents tend to see the past through rose-tinted spectacles.
patronising	N	W1 W2 S	condescendiente: trata a otros como menos capaces; patronising to / towards, it is patronising to suggest that. Como actitud del autor, RDG-P5 §4.4	It is patronising to suggest that older people cannot learn new technology.
hardly a neutral observer	N	W1 W2 S	difícilmente un observador neutral: la fuente tiene interés en el asunto	The report's author, who owns three of the hotels concerned, is hardly a neutral observer.
self-serving	N	W1 W2	interesado: favorece a quien lo dice; a self-serving argument / account	The bank's explanation is transparently self-serving.
self-justifying	N	W1 W2	que se justifica a sí mismo: un relato que existe para defender la conducta de quien lo cuenta	Memoirs by former ministers are often self-justifying.

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
partisan / impartial	N	W1 W2	partidista / imparcial; sustantivos partisanship, impartiality. Como actitud del autor, even-handed (RDG-P5 §4.4)	Only an impartial inquiry will satisfy the families.

6.4 · En la conversación

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
I beg to differ	N	S	permíteme discrepar: cortés y firme, algo formal, a menudo con ironía	Boring? I beg to differ – it's the best thing he's written.
that's a bit of a stretch	H	S	eso es mucho decir, es forzar las cosas	Calling him a genius is a bit of a stretch.
you can't have it both ways	H	S	no puedes defender una cosa y la contraria	You can't have it both ways: either the service is essential or it can be cut.
come off it	H	S	¡anda ya!: rechaza algo que parece absurdo; muy coloquial, solo si el tono lo permite	Come off it – nobody believes that.
I'm not sure that follows	N	S	no estoy seguro de que eso se deduzca: la versión oral de it does not follow (6.2)	I'm not sure that follows – cheaper doesn't necessarily mean worse.
that doesn't wash (with me)	H	S	eso no cuela; también that won't wash	That excuse might work with your boss, but it doesn't wash with me.

> CLAVE
> Una refutación de C2 nombra el fallo. No basta con This is wrong: hay que decir si falla la prueba (cherry-pick, 6.2), la lógica (it does not follow) o la fuente (self-serving). Es el mismo trabajo que piden las preguntas de evaluación del essay (WRT-P1 §5.2).

> OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA
> Beg the question en el sentido de «plantear la pregunta» está tan extendido que nadie lo nota en una conversación, pero en un essay es el ejemplo clásico de uso que un examinador culto censura. Para «plantea la pregunta», raise the question.

Ya en otra teoría

refute, rebut, deny, repudiate (LEX-CNF §10.2) · disingenuous (LEX-CNF §11) · spurious (LEX-CNF §19) · patently false (LEX-COL §3.1) · give the lie to (LEX-COL §7) · hold water, a red herring, neither here nor there (LEX-IDI §10) · a sweeping generalisation, a vested interest (UOE-P1 §3.2) · gloss over (UOE-P1 §7.1) · take sth with a pinch of salt (UOE-P1 §4.2) · at odds with (UOE-P1 §4.3) · beside the point (UOE-P4 §5.2) · this rests on the assumption that, what this overlooks is (WRT-P1 §5.2) · overstate the case (WRT-P1 §5.3) · so-called (RDG-P5 §4.2) · with respect, that's one way of looking at it (LST §3.6) · I'm not sure I'd go that far, nothing of the sort (SPK §6.3) · smack of (LEX-PHV §14)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 1

No serious critic wants to ban cars from the city altogether; by suggesting otherwise, the minister is simply attacking a _____ man.

A straw **B** paper **C** hollow **D** cardboard

Respuesta: A (straw) · a straw man: una versión deformada de la postura contraria, fácil de derribar. No serious critic wants to ban cars altogether muestra que el ministro rebate algo que nadie defiende.

B paper forma a paper tiger (una amenaza que no lo es), no *a paper man.

C hollow forma a hollow victory / promise (vacío, sin valor); no forma esta expresión.

D cardboard se dice de personajes planos (cardboard characters); tampoco forma esta expresión.

7 Evaluar pruebas y argumentos

Evaluar es decir cómo de sólido es algo y con qué vara se mide. Primero, las pruebas (7.1) y los argumentos (7.2); después, el criterio (7.3) y los juicios sobre medidas (7.4) y sobre obras (7.5). La escala de juicio del essay está en WRT-P1 §5.3, y la de la review, en WRT-P2 §7.4.

7.1 · Las pruebas

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
be borne out (by)	N	W1 W2	confirmarse con datos o hechos: the claim is not borne out by the figures. El phrasal bear sth out está en UOE-P1 §7.1; en el essay rinde sobre todo en pasiva y en negativa	Their early optimism has not been borne out by events.
anecdotal	N	W1 W2 S	anecdótico: basado en casos sueltos, no en datos sistemáticos; anecdotal evidence	The evidence for the diet is largely anecdotal.
a self-selected sample	E	W1	una muestra autoseleccionada: responde solo quien quiere, así que no representa al conjunto	Online polls rely on self-selected samples, so their results tell us very little.
skewed (towards)	N	W1 W2	sesgado, desequilibrado: skewed results / figures, skewed towards	The survey was skewed towards younger, wealthier respondents.
(in)conclusive	N	W1 W2	(no) concluyente: pruebas, resultados, estudios	The results of the trial were inconclusive.
robust	N	W1 W2	sólido, riguroso (pruebas, métodos, datos); a robust defence, una defensa enérgica	There is robust evidence that reading to children improves their vocabulary.
counterintuitive	N	W1 W2 S	contraintuitivo: contrario a lo que uno esperaría, aunque sea cierto; también counter-intuitive. Formación, UOE-P3 §6.1	It seems counterintuitive, but building more roads often increases traffic.
point to	N	W1 W2	apuntar a, indicar, sin probarlo del todo: everything points to	Everything points to a simple software error.

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
a knock-down argument	N	W1 W2 S	un argumento demoledor, sin réplica; suele ir en negativa (there is no knock-down argument)	There is no knock-down argument for either side; it comes down to values.
the burden of proof	N	W1	la carga de la prueba: the burden of proof lies with quien afirma algo o quiere cambiarlo	The burden of proof should lie with those who want to change the law.

7.2 · Los argumentos

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
watertight	N	W1 W2	sin fisuras, a prueba de objeciones (un argumento, una coartada, un caso); también airtight, más americano	Her case looked watertight until a new witness came forward.
sound	N	W1 W2	sólido, bien fundado: a sound argument / basis / judgement	The decision rests on sound financial reasoning.
well-founded	N	W1 W2	fundado, justificado (temores, críticas, sospechas). Formación, UOE-P3 §7.2	Their concerns turned out to be well-founded.
plausible / far-fetched	N	W1 W2 S	verosímil / rebuscado, poco creíble; plausible no garantiza que sea cierto. Formación de far-fetched, UOE-P3 §7.2	The explanation is plausible; the alternative is frankly far-fetched.
specious	E	W1	especioso: parece convincente, pero es falso	The argument is specious: it sounds reasonable but ignores the costs entirely.
simplistic / reductive	N	W1 W2	simplista / reduccionista: reduce un problema complejo a una sola causa	It is simplistic to blame social media for every social problem.
contentious	N	W1 W2	polémico, que suscita desacuerdo (una afirmación, una cuestión, una decisión)	The figures behind the decision are highly contentious.
hard / impossible to argue with	N	W1 W2 S	irrebatible; a menudo concede antes de matizar	Her conclusion is hard to argue with: the service is simply too expensive to run.

ESCALA · DE MÁS A MENOS SÓLIDO

watertight → sound / cogent (LEX-COL §5) → plausible → tenuous (LEX-COL §5) → far-fetched → untenable (WRT-P1 §5.3). Specious se sale de la escala: parece plausible y es falso.

7.3 · El criterio

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
judged by X alone	N	W1 W2	si se juzga solo por X: anuncia que ese criterio no basta; judged by numbers / sales / results alone	Judged by sales alone, the novel was a failure.
measured against	N	W1 W2	comparado con, medido según: measured against its own targets	Measured against its own targets, the scheme has failed.
by any measure / standard	N	W1 W2 S	se mire como se mire, con cualquier criterio	By any measure, the festival has been a success.
a yardstick / a benchmark	N	W1 W2	vara de medir, referencia: a yardstick by which to judge, set a benchmark	Exam results are a crude yardstick of a school's quality.
the acid test	N	W1 W2	la prueba de fuego, el criterio decisivo	The acid test of any reform is whether it survives a change of government.
on the face of it	N	W1 W2 S	a primera vista; anuncia que lo aparente no es lo real	On the face of it, the deal looks generous.
on closer inspection / examination	N	W1 W2	examinado con más detenimiento	On closer inspection, most of the new jobs turn out to be part-time.
in absolute / relative terms	N	W1 W2	en términos absolutos / relativos	Spending has risen in absolute terms but fallen as a share of national income.
in its own right	N	W1 W2	por derecho propio, por sí mismo: a writer in her own right	The museum's café has become a destination in its own right.

7.4 · Medidas y efectos

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
salutary	E	W1 W2	saludable, aleccionador (algo desagradable que enseña): a salutary lesson / reminder / warning	The crash was a salutary reminder of how fragile the system is.
corrosive	N	W1 W2	corrosivo: destruye poco a poco (la confianza, la convivencia): a corrosive effect on	Constant scandal has a corrosive effect on public trust.
erode	N	W1 W2	erosionar, minar poco a poco: erode support / standards / confidence; sustantivo erosion. Erode trust ya aparece en SPK §4.6	Years of broken promises have eroded support for the party.
futile	N	W1 W2 S	inútil, vano: a futile attempt / gesture, it is futile to; sustantivo futility	It is futile to ban something that can be bought online in seconds.
self-defeating	N	W1 W2	contraproducente: frustra su propio objetivo; más preciso que counterproductive (UOE-P3 §6.1)	Cutting the marketing budget to save money would be self-defeating.

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
backfire	N	W1 W2 S	salir el tiro por la culata: producir el efecto contrario al buscado	The campaign backfired, drawing attention to the very product it attacked.
do little / nothing / much for	N	W1 W2 S	contribuir poco / nada / mucho a algo: do little for sb's reputation / confidence	The scandal did little for the minister's reputation.
a two-tier system	N	W1 W2	un sistema a dos velocidades: uno para quien puede pagar y otro para el resto	Charging for appointments would create a two-tier health service.
low-stakes / high-stakes	N	W1 W2	de poca / mucha importancia o riesgo: high-stakes exams, a low-stakes quiz; ante sustantivo, con guion	Frequent low-stakes quizzes help students more than a single high-stakes exam.
upheaval	N	W1 W2	trastorno, conmoción: un cambio brusco y desestabilizador; social / political upheaval	The reorganisation caused years of upheaval for very little benefit.
a quick fix / a sticking plaster	N	W1 W2 S	un parche: solución rápida y superficial; sticking plaster es británico	Extra funding is a sticking plaster, not a cure.
a panacea	E	W1	una panacea, remedio para todo; casi siempre en negativa (no panacea)	Technology is no panacea for poor teaching.
a mixed blessing	N	W1 W2 S	algo con ventajas e inconvenientes; menos dramático que a double-edged sword (LEX-IDI §10)	Tourism has been a mixed blessing for the island.

7.5 · Obras, textos y propuestas

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
derivative	N	W2	poco original, que imita lo de otros (una obra, un estilo)	The band's second album is pleasant but derivative.
formulaic	N	W2	de fórmula, previsible: sigue un esquema gastado	The plot is formulaic: we know who the killer is by chapter three.
trite	N	W1 W2	trillado, manido (una idea, un mensaje, una conclusión)	The film's message – that love conquers all – is rather trite.
pedestrian	N	W2	prosaico, sin brillo; en este uso no es «peatonal»	The translation is accurate but pedestrian.
laboured	N	W2	forzado, trabajoso (un chiste, una metáfora, un estilo)	The humour is laboured and the metaphors are strained.
overwrought	N	W2	recargado, excesivamente emotivo (un estilo, una interpretación)	The final chapters are overwrought and sentimental.
self-indulgent	N	W2	complaciente consigo mismo: el autor se recrea sin pensar en el público. Formación, UOE-P3 §6.4	At three and a half hours, the film feels self-indulgent.

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
jargon-filled	N	W1 W2	plagado de jerga; lo contrario, refreshingly free of jargon (LEX-COL §3.1)	The report is so jargon-filled that few councillors will read it.
eye-catching	N	W2	llamativo, vistoso; a veces con reserva: eye-catching but empty. Formación, UOE-P3 §7.2	The building's eye-catching facade hides a cramped interior.
a crowd-pleaser	N	W2 S	algo que gusta al gran público; a veces, con el matiz de poco exigente	The show is a crowd-pleaser rather than a work of art.
a tour de force	N	W2	una proeza de virtuosismo (una interpretación, una novela)	Her performance in the final act is a tour de force.
rehabilitate	N	W2	rehabilitar, devolver el prestigio (a una persona, una obra, una reputación)	The biography sets out to rehabilitate a much-maligned king.

CLAVE

El juicio depende de la vara. Judged by sales alone, on closer inspection e in relative terms anuncian que el criterio obvio engaña y proponen otro: es justo el movimiento que piden las preguntas de evaluación del essay (WRT-P1 §5.2).

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Bear out en pasiva: el sujeto es lo que se confirma y by introduce la prueba (the theory is borne out by the data); al revés no tiene sentido. El participio es borne, no *born.

Ya en otra teoría

compelling evidence, hard evidence, slender evidence, the evidence is thin, a cogent argument, a tenuous link, a moot point (LEX-COL §5) · conspicuously absent (LEX-COL §4.2) · a body of evidence (LEX-COL §9) · corroborate (LEX-PHV §16.2) · largely persuasive, has some merit, untenable (WRT-P1 §5.3) · a compelling case, stand up to scrutiny, difficult to fault, an unintended consequence, come at a cost (WRT-P1 §8.1) · a triumph, accomplished, engaging but uneven, a misfire (WRT-P2 §7.4) · faintly pompous (LEX-COL §3.1) · on its own terms, a case in point, leave a lot to be desired (LEX-IDI §10) · the jury is still out (LEX-IDI §6) · a drop in the ocean (LEX-IDI §13) · hold true, hold good (LEX-COL §8) · spurious, cursory, seminal (LEX-CNF §19) · in terms of (UOE-P4 §7) · far-reaching (UOE-P3 §7.2)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 4

The data collected so far do not support the theory.

BORNE

The theory _____ the data collected so far.

Respuesta: IS NOT BORNE OUT BY (5 palabras).

También: ISN'T BORNE OUT BY · HAS NOT BEEN BORNE OUT BY · HASN'T BEEN BORNE OUT BY · HAS NOT YET BEEN BORNE OUT BY · HAS YET TO BE BORNE OUT BY · IS YET TO BE BORNE OUT BY.

Qué se puntúa: la pasiva negativa con el sujeto cambiado (is not borne) y out by: la partícula del phrasal y la preposición del agente. Sin out no hay phrasal: *is not borne by pierde esa mitad.

8 Sopesar y concluir

El final del essay, del report y de la discusión de la Part 3: poner en la balanza, decidir y, si procede, recomendar o advertir.

8.1 · Sopesar

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
outweigh	N	W1 W2 S	pesar más que, compensar con creces: the benefits (far) outweigh the costs. Formación, UOE-P3 §6.4	In this case, the risks of acting far outweigh the risks of waiting.
offset	N	W1 W2	compensar, contrarrestar un efecto con otro: be (partly) offset by	Higher fares will be partly offset by faster journeys.
set against	N	W1 W2	frente a, en comparación con: pone un factor frente a otro	Set against the cost of doing nothing, the scheme looks cheap.
tip the balance / scales	N	W1 W2 S	inclinar la balanza: el factor que decide	In the end, it was the cost that tipped the balance.
cut both ways	N	W1 W2 S	valer para los dos lados: un argumento o un efecto que favorece y perjudica a la vez	The argument about cost cuts both ways: the new system is cheaper to run but far dearer to install.
the lesser of two evils	N	W1 W2 S	el mal menor	A temporary tax may be the lesser of two evils.
a price worth paying	N	W1 W2 S	un precio que merece la pena pagar (frente a a gamble worth taking, LEX-COL §11)	Some disruption is a price worth paying for a better railway.
a net gain / loss	N	W1 W2	una ganancia / pérdida neta: el resultado tras restar lo negativo	Even allowing for the closures, the scheme produced a net gain of two hundred jobs.
on the plus side / on the downside	H	W2 S	como ventaja / como inconveniente	On the plus side, the flat is close to the station; on the downside, it's tiny.
as a fallback	N	W1 W2 S	como plan de reserva: a fallback position / option; verbo fall back on (UOE-P1 §7.2)	Keep the old system as a fallback in case the new one fails.

8.2 · Concluir

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
on balance	N	W1 W2 S	sopesándolo todo: introduce la conclusión tras pesar pros y contras; no es «en equilibrio». En oral, SPK §4.2	On balance, the case for the new stadium is stronger than the case against.
in the final analysis	E	W1	en última instancia, a fin de cuentas: la conclusión de fondo tras examinarlo todo	In the final analysis, the decision is a political one, not a technical one.
taken together / taken as a whole	N	W1 W2	en conjunto, considerados juntos	Taken together, the studies suggest a modest but real effect.

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
all told	N	W1 W2 S	en total, sumándolo todo	All told, the project cost twice the original estimate.
the upshot (of sth) is (that)	N	W1 W2 S	el resultado, la consecuencia final	The upshot is that nobody now trusts the official figures.
the inescapable conclusion	E	W1	la conclusión ineludible: the inescapable conclusion is that	The inescapable conclusion is that the reforms have failed.
if there is one lesson to be drawn	N	W1 W2	si hay una lección que sacar: draw a lesson / conclusion from	If there is one lesson to be drawn from the affair, it is that cheap solutions rarely stay cheap.
it remains to be seen whether	N	W1 W2	está por ver si: deja la conclusión abierta	It remains to be seen whether the cuts will be reversed.
the bottom line (is)	H	W2 S	lo esencial, en definitiva; también el saldo final de una cuenta	The bottom line is that we simply can't afford it.

8.3 · Recomendar y advertir

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
heed	N	W1 W2	hacer caso de: heed a warning / advice / the lessons of; unheeded, desoído. Pay heed to está en LEX-COL §7	Had ministers heeded their own scientists, the crisis might have been avoided.
harness	N	W1 W2	aprovechar, canalizar (energía, potencial, tecnología, entusiasmo)	Schools should harness pupils' enthusiasm for technology rather than ban it.
would do well to	N	W1 W2 S	haría bien en: recomendación cortés pero firme	The council would do well to consult residents before the next phase.
it is incumbent on / upon sb to	E	W1 W2	es obligación de, corresponde a (muy formal)	It is incumbent on employers to ensure that staff are properly trained.
it would be prudent to	E	W1 W2	sería prudente: recomienda sin imponer; también advisable	It would be prudent to delay the launch until the system has been tested.
a word of warning / caution	N	W2 S	una advertencia: abre un consejo	A word of warning: the museum is closed on Mondays.
a cautionary tale	N	W1 W2	un ejemplo aleccionador, una historia que sirve de advertencia	The collapse of the firm is a cautionary tale for investors.
steer clear of	N	W2 S	mantenerse alejado de, evitar	Anyone with young children would be wise to steer clear of the late shows.
tread carefully	N	W1 W2 S	andar con pies de plomo	The government will need to tread carefully if it wants to keep the unions on side.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

On balance e in the final analysis anuncian la conclusión: no la sustituyen. Detrás tiene que venir la postura afinada, la que responde a la cuestión planteada al principio (WRT-P1 §7.3). Y no se abre un essay con ellas: solo se sopesa lo que ya se ha expuesto.

Ya en otra teoría

weigh up the pros and cons (LEX-COL §6) · a trade-off (SPK §4.6) · strike a balance (UOE-P1 §3.1) · all things considered (SPK §4.2) · ultimately, seen in that light, what both positions share is (WRT-P1 §7.4) · when all's said and done, at the end of the day, the long and the short of it (LST §2.3) · on paper … in practice (LEX-IDI §10) · err on the side of caution (LEX-IDI §5) · caution against, call for (WRT-P1 §4.3) · a note of caution (LEX-COL §9) · the remedy may prove worse than the disease (WRT-P1 §5.2) · it is recommended that (WRT-P2 §6.4)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 1

Planning permission was refused twice, and then the funding fell through. The _____ of all these delays is that the theatre will not reopen until 2029.

A upshot **B** outset **C** uptake **D** outlay

Respuesta: A (upshot) · the upshot of: el resultado final de algo. Of all these delays is that… pide justo eso, la consecuencia.

B outset es el principio de algo y solo va en at / from the outset (LEX-CNF §6.1).

C uptake es la aceptación o el grado de uso de algo nuevo (the uptake of the vaccine); no es una consecuencia.

D outlay es un desembolso inicial (UOE-P3 §7.1); no encaja con of all these delays.

9 Reaccionar en la conversación

Lo que queda de la entrada F: cómo mostrar la actitud ante lo dicho o lo ocurrido en el Speaking y en los textos de tono vivo (article, review, la entrevista de la Part 3 de Listening). El acuerdo y el desacuerdo graduados están en SPK §6.3, y las señales del discurso oral, en LST §2.3.

9.1 · Actitud ante lo dicho o lo ocurrido

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
what grates (on me) is	H	S W2	lo que me irrita, lo que me chirría: grate on / with sb, crispar (un ruido, una actitud, una costumbre)	What grates is the assumption that we'll all just pay up.
(somewhat / much) to my irritation	N	W2 S	para mi irritación: somewhat atenúa, much intensifica; igual con surprise, relief, dismay	Somewhat to my irritation, the meeting started without me.
of all things / people / places	H	S W2	precisamente, nada menos que: subraya lo inesperado o absurdo de la elección	He proposed to her at the dentist's, of all places.
I can't say I'm sorry	H	S	no puedo decir que lo lamente: litotes de alivio o satisfacción, no de pena	They're knocking down the old shopping centre, and I can't say I'm sorry.

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
it irks me (that)	N	S W2	me fastidia que; adjetivo irksome	It irks me that the council never publishes the figures.
galling	N	S W2	irritante y humillante (algo injusto que duele): it is galling to / that	It was galling to see someone else take the credit.
for my sins	H	S	por mis pecados: con humor, explica una tarea pesada que a uno le ha tocado	I'm on the parish council, for my sins.

9.2 · Tono y seriedad

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
half-seriously / half-jokingly	N	S W2	medio en serio / medio en broma	She suggested, only half-jokingly, that we cancel the whole thing.
tongue in cheek	N	W2 S	con ironía, sin hablar en serio; ante sustantivo, tongue-in-cheek	The guide is written very much tongue in cheek.
joking apart / in all seriousness	N	S	bromas aparte, hablando en serio: vuelve al tono serio	Joking apart, the delays are costing people their jobs.
not to put too fine a point on it	N	S W2	hablando claro, sin rodeos: anuncia una crítica directa	Not to put too fine a point on it, the report is a whitewash.
if you'll pardon the pun / expression	N	S W2	si se me permite el juego de palabras / la expresión	The campaign to save the old steam railway has, if you'll pardon the pun, run out of steam.

9.3 · Fórmulas de respuesta

Expresión	Reg.	Paper	Significado y uso	Ejemplo
the least I could do	N	S	era lo mínimo: responde a un agradecimiento quitándose mérito	– Thanks for driving me home. – It was the least I could do.
tell me about it	H	S	¡dímelo a mí!: acuerdo enfático con una queja; no pide que te cuenten nada	– The trains are a nightmare. – Tell me about it.
that makes two of us	H	S	ya somos dos: comparte la situación o el sentimiento del otro	– I'm exhausted. – That makes two of us.
now you're talking	H	S	¡eso ya es otra cosa!: acoge con entusiasmo una propuesta mejor	– What if we took the train instead? – Now you're talking.
so much for	H	S W2	pues vaya con…: constata con ironía que algo no ha servido	So much for the new timetable – the train's late again.
don't get me started (on)	H	S	no me tires de la lengua: anuncia una queja larga (que a menudo llega igualmente)	Don't get me started on the parking.
far be it from me to	N	S W2	lejos de mí…: introduce con falsa modestia una crítica o un consejo	Far be it from me to tell you how to run your business, but…

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Estas fórmulas valen por el momento: tell me about it, so much for o now you're talking solo funcionan como reacción inmediata a algo que se acaba de decir u ocurrir; dichas en frío suenan a lista aprendida (SPK §6.3). Una o dos por test, como mucho.

Ya en otra teoría

I hadn't bargained for, what really struck me, as it turned out (LST §2.3) · rankle (LEX-CNF §15) · I'll drink to that, I couldn't agree more, we may have to differ (SPK §6.3) · let's not get carried away (SPK §6.4) · I tell a lie, on second thoughts (SPK §4.4) · as it happens, come to think of it (SPK §4.3) · fair enough, quite (LST §3.6) · drive sb up the wall, get sb's back up (LEX-IDI §9)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 4

It annoys me that nobody bothered to ask the staff.

GRATES

What _____ nobody bothered to ask the staff.

Respuesta: GRATES ON ME IS THAT (5 palabras).

También: GRATES WITH ME IS THAT · GRATES IS THAT · GRATES ON ME IS THE FACT THAT · GRATES WITH ME IS THE FACT THAT · GRATES IS THE FACT THAT.

Qué se puntúa: la pseudohendida (What … is that), que reorganiza it annoys me that, y grates, que recoge annoys. On me o with me pueden ir o no, pero siempre con preposición: *grates me pierde esa mitad.

10 Tabla de repaso por palabra clave

Las 199 expresiones de este documento (referencia en negrita, a su apartado) y las 152 que se remiten a otras teorías, ordenadas por la palabra clave. Abreviaturas: P1–P4, UOE-P1 a UOE-P4; W1 y W2, WRT-P1 y WRT-P2; R5, RDG-P5; IDI, PHV, COL y CNF, los otros documentos LEX.

Clave	Expresión	Dónde
absolute	in absolute / relative terms	**§7.3**
accomplished	accomplished	W2 §7.4
acid test	the acid test	**§7.3**
admittedly	admittedly	SPK §4.3
advocate	advocate	W1 §4.3
agree	I couldn't agree more	SPK §6.3
all but	all but	R5 §6.3
allege	allege	R5 §4.1
analysis	in the final analysis	**§8.2**
anecdotal	anecdotal	**§7.1**
anything but	anything but	R5 §6.3
arguably	arguably	SPK §4.6
argue	hard / impossible to argue with	**§7.2**
as far as it goes	as far as it goes	W1 §5.3
assert	assert	W1 §4.3
assumption	this rests on the assumption that	W1 §5.2
back up	get sb's back up	IDI §9
backfire	backfire	**§7.4**
balance	on balance	**§8.2**
bargain	I hadn't bargained for	LST §2.3
barring	barring	**§5.1**
be that as it may	be that as it may	P2 §9.2
beg	beg the question	**§6.2**
belie	belie	**§6.1**
beside	beside the point	P4 §5.2
best	at best	P2 §6.3
blessing	a mixed blessing	**§7.4**
body	a body of evidence	COL §9
boil	boil down to	PHV §15
bones	make no bones about	**§3.1**
border	border on	P1 §7.3
borne	be borne out (by)	**§7.1**
both ways	you can't have it both ways	**§6.4**
bottom line	the bottom line (is)	**§8.2**
burden	the burden of proof	**§7.1**
by and large	by and large	P1 §4.1
call for	call for	W1 §4.3
caricature	caricature (n. / v.)	**§6.2**
carried away	let's not get carried away	SPK §6.4

Clave	Expresión	Dónde
case	the case for / against X	**§3.4**
case for saying	there's a case for saying	SPK §4.6
case in point	a case in point	IDI §10
caution	caution against	W1 §4.3
cautionary	a cautionary tale	**§8.3**
champion	champion (v.)	**§3.4**
cherry-pick	cherry-pick	**§6.2**
churlish	it would be churlish to deny (that)	**§4.1**
claim	claim	R5 §4.1
cogent	a cogent argument	COL §5
come down	come down to	PHV §15
come off it	come off it	**§6.4**
come what may	come what may	P2 §9.2
compelling	a compelling case	W1 §8.1
compelling	compelling evidence	COL §5
conceded	it must be conceded that	**§4.1**
conceivably	conceivably / it is not inconceivable that	**§5.3**
conclusive	(in)conclusive	**§7.1**
conflate	conflate X with / and Y	**§5.2**
considered	all things considered	SPK §4.2
conspicuously	conspicuously absent	COL §4.2
contend	contend	W1 §4.3
contention	it is my contention that	**§3.1**
contentious	contentious	**§7.2**
corollary	a corollary (of)	**§5.2**
corrected	I stand corrected	**§4.3**
correlation	correlation is not causation	**§6.2**
corroborate	corroborate	PHV §16.2
corrosive	corrosive	**§7.4**
cost	come at a cost	W1 §8.1
counterintuitive	counterintuitive	**§7.1**
credit	give credit where credit is due	CNF §10.4
crowd-pleaser	a crowd-pleaser	**§7.5**
crux	the crux (of the matter)	**§3.3**
cursory	cursory	CNF §19
cut	cut both ways	**§8.1**
debunk	debunk / explode a myth	**§6.1**

Clave	Expresión	Dónde
degree	a matter of degree (rather than kind)	**§5.2**
demonstrably	demonstrably	**§5.3**
deny	deny	CNF §10.2
deny	I won't deny it	SPK §6.3
derivative	derivative	**§7.5**
desired	leave a lot to be desired	IDI §10
dichotomy	a false dichotomy	**§5.2**
differ	I beg to differ	**§6.4**
differ	we may have to differ	SPK §6.3
discount	discount	**§6.1**
disingenuous	disingenuous	CNF §11
dispute	beyond dispute	**§3.1**
distinction	draw a distinction (between)	**§5.2**
dividing line	the real dividing line	**§3.3**
do little	do little / nothing / much for	**§7.4**
do well	would do well to	**§8.3**
doubt	beyond doubt	P4 §4
doubt	there can be little doubt that	**§3.1**
doubt	there is no doubt that	P4 §4
drink	I'll drink to that	SPK §6.3
drop	a drop in the ocean	IDI §13
due	to give sb / sth their due	**§4.1**
end of the day	at the end of the day	LST §2.3
equal	all (other) things being equal	**§5.1**
erode	erode	**§7.4**
err	err on the side of caution	IDI §5
espouse	espouse	**§3.4**
even so	even so	LST §2.3
evils	the lesser of two evils	**§8.1**
exaggeration	it would be no exaggeration to say that	**§5.3**
extent	to a large extent	P2 §6.3
extent	to the extent that / in so far as	**§5.1**
eye-catching	eye-catching	**§7.5**
face	fly in the face of	**§6.1**
face	on the face of it	**§7.3**
fair	fair enough	LST §3.6
fairness	in fairness (to sb) / to be fair	**§4.1**
fallacy	a fallacy	**§6.1**
fallback	as a fallback	**§8.1**
far be it	far be it from me to	**§9.3**
far from	far from	R5 §6.3
far-reaching	far-reaching	P3 §7.2
fault	difficult to fault	W1 §8.1

Clave	Expresión	Dónde
fine point	not to put too fine a point on it	**§9.2**
follow	it does not follow that	**§6.2**
follow	I'm not sure that follows	**§6.4**
for all	for all + noun	P2 §9.2
for all that	for all that	LST §2.3
formulaic	formulaic	**§7.5**
futile	futile	**§7.4**
galling	galling	**§9.1**
getting away	there is no getting away from (the fact that)	**§4.1**
give	I'll give them that	SPK §6.3
gloss	gloss over	P1 §7.1
go along	I'd go along with that	SPK §6.3
go that far	I'm not sure I'd go that far	SPK §6.3
got	you've got me there	**§4.3**
grant	I'll grant that	SPK §6.3
granted	granted	W1 §5.3
granting	even granting that	**§4.2**
grate	what grates (on me) is	**§9.1**
half-seriously	half-seriously / half-jokingly	**§9.2**
happen	as it happens	SPK §4.3
hard	hard evidence	COL §5
harness	harness	**§8.3**
have us believe	would have us believe	R5 §4.1
having said	having said that	LST §2.3
hazard	I'd hazard a guess that	SPK §5.2
heart	the heart of the matter / argument	**§3.3**
heed	heed	**§8.3**
here nor there	neither here nor there	IDI §10
hold good	hold good	COL §8
hold true	hold true	COL §8
if anything	if anything	R5 §6.3
if at all	if at all	**§5.3**
if not	X, if not Y	**§5.3**
in that	in that	P2 §7.1
inclined	I'd be inclined to think	SPK §4.6
incontrovertible	incontrovertible	**§3.1**
incumbent	it is incumbent on / upon sb to	**§8.3**
inescapable	the inescapable conclusion	**§8.2**
inspection	on closer inspection / examination	**§7.3**
irk	it irks me (that)	**§9.1**
irritation	(somewhat / much) to my irritation	**§9.1**

Clave	Expresión	Dónde
issue	what is at issue	**§3.3**
jargon	jargon-filled	**§7.5**
joking	joking apart / in all seriousness	**§9.2**
judged	judged by X alone	**§7.3**
jury	the jury is still out	IDI §6
knock-down	a knock-down argument	**§7.1**
laboured	laboured	**§7.5**
leap	a leap (of logic)	**§6.2**
least	the least I could do	**§9.3**
lesson	if there is one lesson to be drawn	**§8.2**
level	on some level	**§5.3**
lie	give the lie to	COL §7
lie	I tell a lie	SPK §4.4
light	seen in that light	W1 §7.4
likelihood	in all likelihood	P4 §3.5
long and short	the long and the short of it	LST §2.3
main	in the main	P2 §6.3
maintain	maintain	W1 §4.3
may be so	that may (well) be so, but	**§4.2**
may well	may well	R5 §4.2
measure	by any measure / standard	**§7.3**
measured	measured against	**§7.3**
merit	has some merit	W1 §5.3
merit	not without merit	**§4.1**
merits	whatever its merits	**§4.2**
mildly	to put it mildly	**§5.3**
mind	mind you	SPK §4.3
misfire	a misfire	W2 §7.4
money	for my money	LST §3.2
moot	a moot point	COL §5
much as	much as	W1 §5.3
mutually	mutually exclusive	**§5.2**
net	a net gain / loss	**§8.1**
neutral	hardly a neutral observer	**§6.3**
not so much	not so much X as Y	SPK §4.6
not to say	this is not to say that	W1 §5.3
note of caution	a note of caution	COL §9
odds	at odds with	P1 §4.3
of all	of all things / people / places	**§9.1**
offset	offset	**§8.1**
on paper	on paper … in practice	IDI §10
one thing	it is one thing to X, (and / but) quite another to Y	**§4.2**
outweigh	outweigh	**§8.1**

Clave	Expresión	Dónde
overlook	what this overlooks is	W1 §5.2
overstate	overstate the case	W1 §5.3
overwrought	overwrought	**§7.5**
own terms	on its own terms	IDI §10
panacea	a panacea	**§7.4**
pardon	if you'll pardon the pun / expression	**§9.2**
partisan	partisan / impartial	**§6.3**
patently	patently false	COL §3.1
patronising	patronising	**§6.3**
peddle	peddle	**§6.3**
pedestrian	pedestrian	**§7.5**
per se	per se	**§5.2**
persuasive	largely persuasive	W1 §5.3
pinch of salt	take sth with a pinch of salt	P1 §4.2
plausible	plausible / far-fetched	**§7.2**
plus	on the plus side / on the downside	**§8.1**
point	fair point	**§4.3**
point	I take your point	SPK §6.3
point	point taken	**§4.3**
point	point to	**§7.1**
point	sb has a point	**§4.1**
pompous	faintly pompous	COL §3.1
precondition	a precondition (for / of)	**§5.2**
premise	a false premise	**§6.2**
prevailing	the prevailing view	**§3.4**
price	a price worth paying	**§8.1**
proponents	proponents / detractors	**§3.4**
prudent	it would be prudent to	**§8.3**
purport	purport to	**§3.4**
purveyor	purveyor	**§6.3**
quick fix	a quick fix / a sticking plaster	**§7.4**
quite	quite	LST §3.6
rankle	rankle	CNF §15
rash	it would be rash to	R5 §4.2
reason	have every reason to	**§3.1**
reason	it stands to reason (that)	**§3.1**
reason	within reason	**§5.1**
rebut	rebut	CNF §10.2
recommended	it is recommended that	W2 §6.4
red herring	a red herring	IDI §10
refute	refute	CNF §10.2
rehabilitate	rehabilitate	**§7.5**
remains	it remains to be seen whether	**§8.2**

Clave	Expresión	Dónde
remedy	the remedy may prove worse than the disease	W1 §5.2
remotely	not remotely	**§5.3**
repudiate	repudiate	CNF §10.2
respect	with respect	LST §3.6
reverse	the reverse is true	**§6.1**
right	in its own right	**§7.3**
robust	robust	**§7.1**
romanticise	romanticise	**§6.3**
rose-tinted	(through) rose-tinted spectacles	**§6.3**
said and done	when all's said and done	LST §2.3
salutary	salutary	**§7.4**
school of thought	there's a school of thought that	LST §3.2
scrutiny	not bear (close) scrutiny / examination	**§6.1**
scrutiny	stand up to scrutiny	W1 §8.1
second thoughts	on second thoughts	SPK §4.4
see	the way I see it	SPK §4.2
seem	it would seem that	**§3.2**
self-defeating	self-defeating	**§7.4**
self-evident	self-evident	**§3.1**
self-indulgent	self-indulgent	**§7.5**
self-justifying	self-justifying	**§6.3**
self-selected	a self-selected sample	**§7.1**
self-serving	self-serving	**§6.3**
seminal	seminal	CNF §19
sense	in a sense	SPK §4.3
set against	set against	**§8.1**
share	what both positions share is	W1 §7.4
simplistic	simplistic / reductive	**§7.2**
sins	for my sins	**§9.1**
skewed	skewed (towards)	**§7.1**
slender	slender evidence	COL §5
slippery slope	a slippery slope	**§6.2**
smack	smack of	PHV §14
so much for	so much for	**§9.3**
so-called	so-called	R5 §4.2
something of a	something of a + juicio	**§5.3**
something to be said	there is something to be said for	W1 §5.3
sorry	I can't say I'm sorry	**§9.1**
sort	nothing of the sort	SPK §6.3
sound	sound	**§7.2**
specious	specious	**§7.2**
spurious	spurious	CNF §19

Clave	Expresión	Dónde
stakes	low-stakes / high-stakes	**§7.4**
started	don't get me started (on)	**§9.3**
steer	steer clear of	**§8.3**
straw man	a straw man	**§6.2**
stretch	that's a bit of a stretch	**§6.4**
strictly	strictly speaking	**§5.1**
strike	strike a balance	P1 §3.1
strike	what really struck me	LST §2.3
such	as such (= en sí mismo)	**§5.1**
sufficient	necessary but not sufficient	**§5.2**
sweeping	a sweeping generalisation	P1 §3.2
taken together	taken together / taken as a whole	**§8.2**
talking	now you're talking	**§9.3**
tell	tell me about it	**§9.3**
tend	tends to	R5 §4.2
tentative	tentative / tentatively	**§3.2**
tenuous	a tenuous link	COL §5
terms	in terms of	P4 §7
that said	that said	LST §2.3
thin	the evidence is thin	COL §5
think	come to think of it	SPK §4.3
though	Frail though she was	P2 §9.1
tip	tip the balance / scales	**§8.1**
told	all told	**§8.2**
tongue	tongue in cheek	**§9.2**
tour de force	a tour de force	**§7.5**
trade-off	a trade-off	SPK §4.6
tread	tread carefully	**§8.3**
trite	trite	**§7.5**
triumph	a triumph	W2 §7.4
trivialise	trivialise / demonise / sensationalise	**§6.3**
truth	nothing could be further from the truth	**§6.1**
turn out	as it turned out	LST §2.3
two of us	that makes two of us	**§9.3**
two-tier	a two-tier system	**§7.4**
ultimately	ultimately	W1 §7.4
underlying	underlying	**§3.3**
understand	as I understand it	**§3.2**
uneven	engaging but uneven	W2 §7.4
unfounded	unfounded / groundless	**§6.1**
unintended	an unintended consequence	W1 §8.1
unreasonable	it is not unreasonable to suppose that	**§3.2**
untenable	untenable	W1 §5.3

Clave	Expresión	Dónde
up to a point	up to a point	W1 §5.3
upheaval	upheaval	**§7.4**
upshot	the upshot (of sth) is (that)	**§8.2**
venture	I would venture (to suggest) that	**§3.2**
verge	verge on	P1 §7.3
vested	a vested interest	P1 §3.2
view	be (firmly) of the view that	**§3.1**
wall	drive sb up the wall	IDI §9
wash	that doesn't wash (with me)	**§6.4**
water	hold water	IDI §10
watertight	watertight	**§7.2**
way	in a way	SPK §4.3
way of looking	that's one way of looking at it	LST §3.6
weigh up	weigh up the pros and cons	COL §6
well	(be) all very well / all well and good	**§4.2**
well-founded	well-founded	**§7.2**
word	a word of warning / caution	**§8.3**
worst	at worst	P2 §6.3
worth	for what it's worth	**§3.2**
yardstick	a yardstick / a benchmark	**§7.3**